

Facilitator guide — Instance Setup

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About these activities

Instance Setup is the hands-on configuration sequence — participants connect a country's DHIS2 data into a FASTR instance. The five activities run in a **strict order**: each step depends on the one before it, and mistakes cascade — a wrong indicator mapping in step 3 surfaces as a wrong number in step 5.

Five handouts, run in order. **~90 min** of participant time. Most failures here are credential or mapping mistakes, not conceptual ones.

How to run it

- This is a **guided sequence** — keep the room together, step by step. Don't let people race ahead.
- The handouts are detailed procedures. Demo the first few clicks of each step, then let participants follow the handout at their own pace.
- Have **DHIS2 credentials** and each team's **Data Prep Checklist** confirmed *before* you start — missing access stalls the whole room.
- If anyone falls behind, **pause the room**. Later steps will not work without the earlier ones completed.

The activities

1. Before you begin

Orientation · ~5 min

What it is — an orientation page that previews the four-step sequence and explains how DHIS2 credentials are handled.

What the handout covers — participants gather what they need (filled Data Prep Checklist, DHIS2 URL / username / password, a stable browser); there is no separate "connect" step — credentials are entered on the first import.

Watch for — tell participants to tick "**Save credentials for this session**" on the first prompt, or they will be re-prompted on every later import.

2. Import facility structure

Setup procedure · ~20 min

What it is — a step-by-step procedure to pull the country admin hierarchy into FASTR.

What the handout covers — Data → Structure & maps → Admin areas → import directly from DHIS2 → select the **Facility** level → finalize until the Structure & maps tile turns green.

Watch for — an empty facility list or a wrong-looking hierarchy usually means the wrong DHIS2 level was picked, or the user lacks org-unit read access. Auth failures are typically a malformed URL.

3. Import and map indicators

Setup procedure · ~30 min

What it is — a three-phase procedure to define and map indicators. The longest and most error-prone step.

What the handout covers — create common indicators, import the country's DHIS2 indicator names, then map each DHIS2 indicator to its common counterpart.

Watch for — a rejected Common ID means a space, accent, or special character was used: insist on lowercase letters and underscores only. Each DHIS2 indicator maps to **exactly one** common indicator.

4. Import HMIS data

Setup procedure · ~25 min

What it is — the largest data operation in setup: pulling actual HMIS data values from DHIS2.

What the handout covers — select indicators and a time range, set error handling to "**Abort the entire import attempt**", fetch, review the import summary, then integrate and finalize.

Watch for — large pulls can freeze the browser. Warn participants not to close the tab mid-fetch; for large countries, narrow the indicators / time range and import in batches.

5. Verify and explore your setup

Setup procedure · ~10 min

What it is — a verification step to spot-check imported data and learn the chart explorer.

What the handout covers — view indicators as time series, toggle indicators, adjust the y-axis scale, spot-check a known facility value against DHIS2, and review import history.

Watch for — flat or zero values usually mean the period range does not overlap DHIS2 data. A mismatched spot-check almost always traces back to **incomplete indicator mapping in step 3** — send them back there.

Wrapping up

The setup is only "done" when the verify step passes. If a spot-check fails, do not move on — the rest of the workshop runs on this data.